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“We are not selling cars... We are selling dreams”

Lamborghini Chairman & CEO Stephan Winkelmann on the Indian luxury car market, selling dreams to customers, and the way ahead

PHOTOS BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

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t is obvious that Stephan Winkelmann, 59, likes India. Its clear growth story can only lead to more demand for the luxury cars. As Chairman & CEO of Italian luxury sports carmaker Automobili Lamborghini, the auto industry veteran runs a company—owned by Volkswagen Group through subsidiary Audi—famous for its supercars. Sitting in a luxury car showroom in central Mumbai, a cheerful Winkelmann sounds optimistic about India and not without reason. Last year, his company got past the three-digit mark in sales volumes. It sells three models here—sports car Huracán, sports utility vehicle Urus, and Revuelto, a hybrid sports car. It is not easy to push luxury cars in India, though the numbers are now encouraging. In an interview with *Business Today's Krishna Gopalan*, Winkelmann speaks about India, the need to have a specific strategy for the market, and what it means to sell dreams, among other things. Edited excerpts: